

“Stackolee”: A Floating Ballad Text resubmission

Recommendation: accept for publication

This revision has a clearer organization and more precisely explains its primary claims in the introduction (especially on the 3rd page). The song analyses and information about blues and country schemas are fascinating, and the conclusion about the close association between schemas and lyrical themes provides new insight into the style.

I have only a few friendly suggestions for revision:

P. 11: “Eight-bar blues *schemes* are combinations of the 7,5 phrase rhythm with specific harmonic progressions and melodic designs.”

This definition of a scheme does not quite match how the article defines a ballad scheme on p. 7: “combinations or *ballad meter* with specific harmonic progressions and melodic designs[.]” (emphasis added). That is, p.7 defines a scheme as a combination of melody/harmony with a poetic meter (which includes phrase rhythm), while p.11 defines a scheme as a combination of melody/harmony with phrase rhythm only. It then brings up “poetic forms” later in the paragraph without stating that these are relevant in the definition.

To avoid confusion and to be consistent with terminology, I suggest a rewrite along the lines of “Eight-bar blues *schemes* are combinations of the 7,5 phrase rhythm with specific harmonic progressions, melodic designs, and poetic forms.”

p. 13: The author references a “minimal number of seven accents.” Since “accent” has not been discussed for several pages and could have several possible meanings, consider changing the passage to “the minimal number of accents (that is, the combination of a stressed syllable and metrically strong position)” to be consistent with how accents are discussed on p. 10.

P. 16: Change “higher hypermetric level” to “higher metric level.” “Higher hypermetric level” is redundant.

Example 11b: Fix the key signature on the second two staves of this example. It switches from E major to D major.